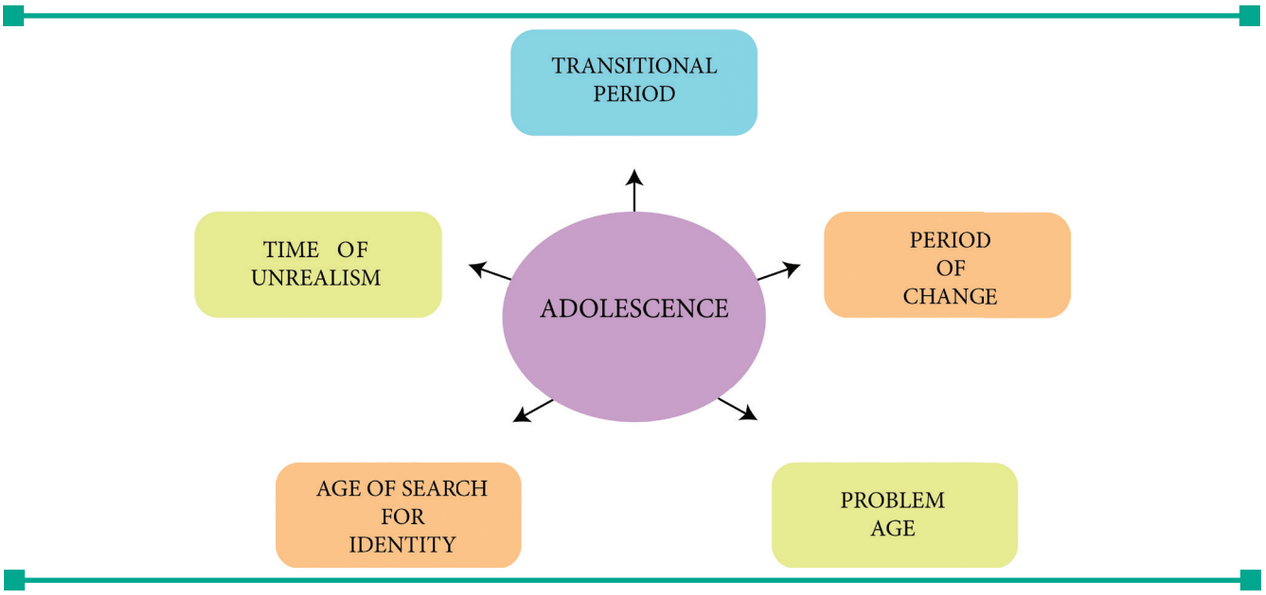


▲ Fig. 8 Characteristics of the adolescent period

sex characteristics between boys and girls are given in the table above:

(b) Cognitive changes in adolescents .

WHAT IS COGNITION?

It is the mental action or process of acquiring knowledge and understanding through experiences.

In this stage, adolescents develop the ability to process information, improve in areas of decision making, memory, critical thinking and self-regulatory learning. This is known as the 'Formal Operation Stage of Development'

(c) Social Changes and Development During Adolescence

Friendship during adolescence is based on similarities and interests . The common social groups in adolescence is as follows:

Chums- close friends – They are inseperable companions as confidants
Cliques – They are made up of groups of close friends

Crowds – they are made up of cliques and close friends
Organised groups – These groups are planned by orgainised sectors like schools, churches or community centres

Gangs- They are a group of boys and/or girls who are poorly adjusted to society

Individual activity 3

Who are your chums? – What criteria do you have to select your confidants?

How many members are there in your clique? What are your common interests?

Are you part of an organized group? List any three social causes addressed by your group.

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